reached my goals, Kalam! You have eclipsed them," he told me in a voice choked with emotion.

The next month, I happened to be in Trichi and used that opportunity to visit St. Joseph's Col ege. I did not find Rev. Father Sequeira, Rev. Father Erhart, Prof. Subramanyam, Prof. Iyyamperumal Konar, or Prof. Thothathri Iyengar there, but it seemed to me that the stones of the St. Joseph's building stil carried the imprint of the wisdom of those great people. I shared with the young students my memories of St. Joseph's and paid tribute to the teachers who had moulded me.

We celebrated the nation's forty-fourth Independence Day with the test firing of Akash. Prahlada and his team evaluated a new solid propel ant booster system based on a composite modified double base propel ant. This propel ant with its unprecedented high energy properties was crucial in assuring the long-range surface-to-air missiles. The country had taken an important step in ground-based air defence of vulnerable areas.

Towards the end of 1990, Jadavpur University conferred on me the honour of Doctor of Science at a special convocation. I was a little embarrassed at finding